RANSOMWARE RESPONSE GUIDE

What to do in the first 60 minutes · South Africa · POPIA Aligned

GREYHAT 4 HIRE

24/7 INCIDENT RESPONSE
+27 84 651 3581
www.greyhat4hire.co.za
South Africa's Premier Cybersecurity Response Team

■ RANSOMWARE DETECTED — ACT IMMEDIATELY — DO NOT REBOOT ■

IMMEDIATE RESPONSE STEPS — First 15 Minutes

1 STOP — Do Not Reboot
Do NOT power off or restart.
You will destroy critical forensic evidence.

2 Disconnect From Network
Unplug ethernet immediately.
Disable Wi-Fi — do not just disconnect.

3 Call Your IR Team NOW
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Do not attempt remediation yourself.

4 Photograph the Ransom Screen
Capture every screen with your phone.
Note all open applications and timestamps.

5 Isolate Related Systems
Disconnect systems on the same segment.
Includes any host sharing file access.

6 Notify Practice Leadership
Alert CEO / CISO / Practice Manager.
Activate your written Incident Response Plan.

WHAT NOT TO DO — Mistakes That Destroy Recovery

Do NOT pay the ransom
Payment does not guarantee recovery and funds criminals.

Do NOT reboot or shut down
Preserving volatile memory is critical for forensics.

Do NOT delete logs or files
All evidence is required for POPIA & legal proceedings.

Do NOT notify staff broadly
Limit knowledge — avoid panic, leaks and gossip.

Do NOT use the infected system
Activity may trigger further encryption or data loss.

Do NOT post on social media
Public statements must go through legal counsel first.

POPIA NOTIFICATION OBLIGATIONS — Section 22

72 HRS — Notify Information Regulator
Report to inforegulator.org.za within 72 hours of breach.

ASAP — Notify Affected Data Subjects
Contact all persons whose health data was compromised.

WRITTEN — Formal Written Submission Required
Detail nature, scope, data categories and remediation.

3 YEARS — Retain All Documentation
Keep breach records and notifications for 3 years minimum.

EVIDENCE PRESERVATION — Order of Volatility

1. **CPU / RAM Memory**
   Capture FIRST — lost permanently on shutdown.
2. **Active Network Connections**
   ARP tables, open sockets and active sessions.
3. **Running Processes**
   Open file handles, services and child processes.
4. **Ransom Note & Screen**
   Photograph immediately before any interaction.
5. **Windows / Linux Event Logs**
   Export all logs before any system shutdown.
6. **Disk Image**
   Forensic copy only — never use the live system.
7. **External Backups**
   Verify integrity — they may also be encrypted.

COMMON RANSOMWARE VARIANTS — Know Your Adversary

LockBit 3.0
Fast encryption + double extortion. Exfiltrates data before encrypting.

ALPHV / BlackCat
Rust-based, multi-platform. Targets Windows, Linux and ESXi hosts.

Royal / BlackSuit
Targets health, education and critical national infrastructure.

Cl0p
Exploits file-transfer tools — MOVEit and GoAnywhere vulnerabilities.

MedusaLocker
SMB propagation. Specifically targets African organisations repeatedly.

RANSOMWARE RESPONSE TIMELINE

0–5 MIN	5–15 MIN	15–30 MIN	30–60 MIN	1–4 HRS	4–24 HRS	24–72 HRS	72+ HRS
Detect & Disconnect	Alert & Isolate	Engage IR Team	Preserve Evidence	Notify Regulator	Assess Scope	Recovery Plan	POPIA Compliance

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